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The AI Program Guide for Fitness Professionals

Custom training + nutrition + follow-up for every client — in minutes, and built to scale

growtify.ai — GROWT Method

Who Is This Guide For?

This guide is for personal trainers, fitness studio owners, and nutrition coaches who burn hours writing a custom program for every client, lose people because they can't keep up with check-ins, and feel pulled in two directions between group classes and one-on-one coaching.

What's Inside This Guide?

- 5 AI tools — hand-picked for a fitness practice (Claude, ChatGPT, Trainerize, Canva AI, WhatsApp Business)
 - 3 practical scenarios — training program generation, nutrition planning, and motivation tracking
 - 10 copy-paste prompts — ready-made programs across a level × goal × equipment matrix
 - First-7-days checklist — to rebuild your client systems with AI
 - A motivation message template pack — ready to go for every day of the week
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You've got 15 clients, and writing a custom program for each one runs 10 hours a week. The motivation messages, the check-ins, the nutrition tweaks pile up — and then 'I don't have time' turns into a client walking out the door. AI takes that load off your plate, so you can focus on coaching and results.

Why AI Matters

The fitness industry is being reshaped around personalization. Clients no longer settle for generic programs — a 'made for you' experience has become the baseline expectation. But personalization means time, and what used to be the exclusive luxury of top-tier trainers is now within reach of every coach through AI. Global brands like Nike Training Club, Future, and Freeletics already deliver a 'personal' experience to millions through AI-assisted programming.

The opportunity for independent PTs and small studios is real: use the same tools, then pair them with local, personal service to compete with the big brands. A trainer who can deliver a personal program + follow-up + motivation to 50 clients at once spends the same hours as a trainer maxed out at 10 — but produces 5x the revenue.

The Numbers

89%

Share of fitness clients who prefer services offering a 'personal program' over generic, off-the-shelf plans.

ACSM Health & Fitness Journal, 2024

3x

How much more likely clients are to still be active after 6 months when they get regular check-ins and motivation — vs. no follow-up at all.

IHRSA Global Fitness Report, 2023

62%

Lift in client satisfaction and repeat purchases for trainers who pair their training with a nutrition plan.

NSCA Personal Trainer Journal, 2024

WITHOUT AI

- Every custom program: 45-60 minutes to write and update
- Motivation messages done by hand — and mostly never sent, so clients drift away

WITH AI

- Level + goal + equipment in → AI returns a 4-week program in 10 minutes
- Ready-made motivation templates for every day of the week, sent in 2 minutes

- Nutrition planning treated as a separate specialty you can't offer
- Client progress tracked subjectively, with no objective data behind it

- A calorie- and macro-based nutrition plan ready with AI — a new revenue stream
- Photo + measurement analysis turned into an objective progress report with AI

Scenario 1: Scenario 1: Generating a Custom Training Program

Problem:

A new client comes in: 32 years old, 6 months postpartum, 3 days a week at 45 minutes, training at home with dumbbells, goal 'recovery + fat loss'. Writing a 4-week program tailored to that profile normally takes an hour. With 10 clients, that's 10 hours a week.

Step-by-Step

- Standardize your client intake form (age, health history, goal, experience, equipment, time)
- Feed that information to Claude and use the program prompt below
- AI generates a 4-week progressive program — sets/reps/rest plus form cues
- Apply your own expertise to revise 2-3 exercises (for the client's specific situation)
- Export to PDF or Trainerize/your app and deliver it to the client — ready in 10 minutes

EXAMPLE PROMPT

You are an experienced fitness program designer. Build a 4-week custom training program based on the profile below.

Client profile:

- Age: [X] | Sex: [F/M]
- Height/Weight: [X cm / Y kg]
- Fitness experience level: [Beginner / Intermediate / Advanced]
- Health status: [Add any special notes: knee pain, postpartum, hypertension, etc.]
- Goal: [Lose fat / Build muscle / Cardiovascular conditioning / Recovery / Performance]
- Current activity: [Sedentary / Active X days a week]
- Time: [X] days a week, [Y] minutes per session
- Equipment: [Home / Studio / Full gym + list]
- Special request: [If any — e.g. lunch-break at the office, early morning]

Build a 4-week progressive program:

- Week 1: Adaptation — light load, form-focused
- Week 2: Volume increase
- Week 3: Intensity/load increase
- Week 4: Peak + deload (last 3 days light)

For each training day:

1. Warm-up (5 minutes, dynamic movements)
2. Main block: exercises + sets × reps + rest (e.g. 3 × 12, 60 sec rest)
3. Finisher (optional — HIIT, run, foam roll)

4. Cool-down + stretching (5 minutes)

For each exercise:

- Exercise name
- Sets × reps (+ tempo, if any)
- Rest
- One key form cue (1 sentence)
- An alternative movement (if equipment is missing or there's pain)

WARNING: If there's postpartum recovery, chronic pain, or cardiovascular risk, open the program with: "This program is a general guide. If you experience pain or discomfort, consult a health professional."

Tone: motivating but safe, professional, easy to follow.

BEFORE

4-week custom program: 45-60 minutes per client

AFTER

Form + AI program + personal revision: 10-15 minutes per client

Scenario 2: Scenario 2: Nutrition Plan and Calorie Calculation

Problem:

The client asks: 'What should I be eating?' That's a dietitian's job — but when you can't even offer a general roadmap, your perceived value drops. Building a nutrition plan yourself eats hours, and the calorie math is a whole separate task.

Step-by-Step

- Collect the client profile (for the TDEE calculation: age, weight, height, activity, goal)
- Feed it to Claude and use the nutrition plan prompt
- AI produces TDEE + macro targets + a 7-day sample menu (with everyday, accessible foods)
- Add the standard disclaimer: 'General guide — see a dietitian if there's a chronic condition'
- Deliver it to the client as a PDF — bundle it into the package as an optional add-on service

EXAMPLE PROMPT

Build a personalized nutrition guide for [client name].

Profile:

- Age/Sex: [X / F or M]
- Height/Weight: [cm / kg]
- Activity level: [Sedentary / Light / Moderate / Intense / Very intense]
- Goal: [Lose fat / Build muscle / Maintain / Performance]
- Target rate: [e.g. 0.5 kg change per week]
- Allergies/dislikes: [List if any]
- Budget level: [Economical / Moderate / Flexible]
- Preferences: [Whole-food focus — note any dietary restrictions, e.g. vegetarian, halal, gluten-free]

Produce:

1. TDEE calculation (Mifflin-St Jeor formula, step by step)
2. Daily target calories and macros (protein/carbs/fat)
3. A 7-day sample menu (breakfast, lunch, dinner, 2 snacks)
 - Each meal: dish name + portion + estimated calories + macros
 - Whole, accessible foods (legumes, lentils, chicken, fish, yogurt, vegetables, whole grains)
 - Budget-friendly choices
4. A practical weekly shopping list
5. Meal-prep tips
6. Hydration and supplement guidance (general)

WARNING — mandatory, at the very top of the plan:

"This plan is a general guide. If you have diabetes, a thyroid condition, are pregnant, have kidney disease, an eating disorder, or any chronic health condition, please consult a registered dietitian. No supplement should be used without approval from a doctor or pharmacist."

Tone: practical, encouraging, not overly restrictive (favor 'this week, lean into X' over 'forbidden' language).

BEFORE

Nutrition plan: either refer it out to a specialist (lost revenue) or burn 2 hours

AFTER

AI nutrition guide + disclaimer + personal touch: 20-25 minutes, plus added revenue

Scenario 3: Scenario 3: Motivation and Follow-Up System

Problem:

Monday, after the session, the client says 'I feel amazing.' Tuesday, silence. Wednesday, no workout. Thursday, 'I couldn't get motivated — cancel.' Sending a motivation message once a week keeps a client happy for 3 months — but $20 \text{ clients} \times 3 \text{ messages a week} = 60 \text{ messages by hand, every week}$.

Step-by-Step

- Define your client segments (just starting, plateau, near goal, long-term performance)
- Have Claude generate a motivation message template for each segment $\times$ each day
- Save those templates as 'quick replies' in WhatsApp Business — 30 templates
- 10 minutes a day: personalize and send the right template to clients scheduled to train that day
- Every 2 weeks, request a progress photo + measurements — build the progress report with Claude

EXAMPLE PROMPT

Build motivation message templates for my fitness clients, covering every day of the week.

Client segments:

1. Just starting (0-4 weeks) — motivated but anxious
2. Plateau phase (8-12 weeks) — progress has slowed, demotivated
3. Near goal (final 4 weeks) — last push, may feel pressure
4. Long-term (6+ months) — sustainability, lifestyle

For each segment, across all 7 days of the week (21 messages total):

Monday: Start of the week, set the intention

Tuesday: Keep them motivated, nudge them to move

Wednesday: Midweek, a mental reset

Thursday: The energy-dip day, support

Friday: Closing out the week, a recap

Saturday: Active rest, a balanced approach

Sunday: Prep for the week ahead

Each message:

- Max 3 sentences
- WhatsApp tone (warm, 1-2 emojis maximum)
- 'You' language, personal
- An invitation, not an instruction (not "do it!" but "want to start a little mental challenge today to see how much you can move?")

- Fitted to the segment (for the beginner: confidence; plateau: trust the process; near goal: resilience; long-term: meaning in the lifestyle)

WARNING: No judgmental language about body shape. Put the process and how they feel up front; results and appearance stay in the background.

BEFORE

20 clients × 3 motivation messages/week: 60 messages written by hand, most forgotten

AFTER

21 templates × personalization: 15 minutes a week, every client gets a touchpoint

Recommended AI Tools

Claude (claude.ai)

Free

The most capable AI assistant for training programs, nutrition plans, motivation content, and client reports.

Best for: Program design, nutrition planning, motivation, progress reports

Trainerize / FitSW (trainerize.com)

Paid

A client management, program delivery, and progress-tracking platform built for personal trainers.

Best for: Client tracking, program delivery, progress photos, follow-up

WhatsApp Business (business.whatsapp.com)

Free

Motivation messages, quick Q&A, and broadcast announcements with ready-made quick replies.

Best for: Motivation messages, reminders, fast replies

Canva AI (canva.com)

Free

For Instagram fitness content, PDF program templates, and exercise cards.

Best for: Instagram reels, program PDFs, exercise cards, before/after collages

MyFitnessPal / Yazio

Free

Calorie and macro tracking for clients — you can plug your AI nutrition plan straight into it.

Best for: Client calorie tracking, macros, food diary

Copy-Paste Prompt Pack

1. 1. 4-Week Training Program

Build a 4-week progressive training program for [client profile: age/sex/weight/height/goal/experience/equipment/days × minutes per week]. Week 1 adaptation, 2 volume, 3 intensity, 4 peak+deload. Each day: warm-up + main block (exercise × sets × reps × rest × form cue) + cool-down. Health disclaimer at the top.

Expected output: A full 4-week program with daily detail

2. 2. Nutrition Plan (TDEE + Menu)

Build a personal nutrition guide for [profile: age/weight/height/activity/goal]. TDEE via Mifflin-St Jeor, target calories + macros, a 7-day whole-food menu (budget-friendly), shopping list, meal-prep tip, hydration. Mandatory health disclaimer at the very top.

Expected output: TDEE + 7-day menu + shopping list

3. 3. Motivation Message Set

Build a 7-day motivation message template set for my [segment: new/plateau/near goal/long-term] client. Each message max 3 sentences, warm WhatsApp tone, 'you' language, an invitation not an instruction, no body judgment, process-focused. 7 separate messages.

Expected output: A 7-day motivation template set

4. 4. Progress Report

Write a 4-week progress report for [client]. Data: weight [X→Y], waist measurement [A→B], training adherence rate [Z%], subjective note [X]. Report: warm opening of recognition, the concrete numbers, one strength, one area to improve + a concrete action, and the focus for the next 4 weeks. 200 words.

Expected output: A client-ready progress report

5. 5. Instagram Reel Script

Write a 30-second Instagram reel script on [topic: e.g. '5-minute core at home', 'exercises for back pain at home']. Hook (3 sec) + 3 movements (each with a camera angle + text overlay) + CTA. Caption 100 words + 10 hashtags.

Expected output: A reel script + caption

6. 6. Client Assessment Questions

Build an assessment-form question set for new client onboarding. 5 headings: health history, training history, goals, obstacles, preferences. Under each heading, 4-6 open questions + any ready-made options. To be sent as a WhatsApp message or Google Form.

Expected output: A client onboarding form set

7. 7. Group Class Plan

Build a [X-minute] group class plan for [class type: HIIT/Pilates/Bootcamp]. Level: [mixed/beginner/advanced]. Warm-up + main block (circuit/set structure) + cool-down. For each movement: timing, level modifications (easier/harder), instructor checkpoint. Music tempo suggestion.

Expected output: A complete group class plan template

8. 8. Injury/Pain Modification

A client reported pain in their [area: knee/lower back/shoulder]. Their current program includes [exercise list]. Suggest safe alternatives (2 alternatives per exercise), which movements to avoid, and when to refer them to a health professional. Disclaimer: 'For acute pain, only after a medical check.'

Expected output: A safe modification guide

9. 9. Pricing/Package Explainer Message

Write a price-value explainer for a prospect about [package: 1-1 PT / group / online]. Package contents: [list]. Value emphasis: what they get. Payment terms: [detail]. A 250-word WhatsApp version + a 100-word Instagram DM version. Warm but professional.

Expected output: A sales message for two channels

10. 10. Educational Blog/Instagram Post

Write an Instagram educational post on [topic: e.g. 'how much weight a woman should lift when starting out', 'how to train with back pain']. 250-word caption, 3 main points, a myth/fact contrast, 10 hashtags. Speak to the FAQ language your audience is actually searching for.

Expected output: An educational Instagram post

Your First 7 Days

One step a day. By the end of the week, you'll have seen your first results.

- ☐ Day 1: Sign up for Claude.ai. Generate a 4-week training program with Prompt 1 for 2 clients (new or existing). Finish with your own revision, then send.
- ☐ Day 2: Build nutrition guides for your 3 most active clients with Prompt 2. Check the disclaimer, then send as a PDF.
- ☐ Day 3: Move into WhatsApp Business. Generate a 3 segments x 7 days motivation template set with Prompt 3. Save them as quick replies.
- ☐ Day 4: Build an assessment form for onboarding with Prompt 6. Set it up as a Google Form and add it to your new-client flow.
- ☐ Day 5: Build a progress report for your longest-standing client with Prompt 4. Add before/after photos + measurements, then present it to the client.
- ☐ Day 6: Generate 3 Instagram reel scripts with Prompt 5 in Canva AI, shoot them, and schedule them for the week.
- ☐ Day 7: Measure this week's client engagement time. Write and publish an educational post with Prompt 10. Map out the plan for next week.

Transform with the GROWT Method

You've systematized program generation, nutrition planning, and motivation follow-up. The real growth opportunity is turning that system into capacity growth and online service — from 10 clients to 50, from the studio to online. Plan that transition with the GROWT Method. For your personal plan, head to growtify.ai/test.

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-  **G — Gap Analysis**
 -  **R — Roadmap**
 -  **O — Operationalize**
 -  **W — Win**
 -  **T — Transform**

This guide gave you a starting point. With the GROWT Method's structured process, complete the full transformation across 5 levels.

growtify.ai/test → **Build your plan**

Next step: Get the AI Growth Plan for Your PT Practice / Studio

You've sped up your programming, nutrition, and follow-up processes. Next comes growing your capacity, building an online revenue stream, and growing as a brand. Take the free AI Digital Maturity Test at growtify.ai/test — your business-specific roadmap in 5 minutes.

Build Your Plan →

growtify.ai/test